

# ISHANK WALIA

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior QA Engineer specialising in **DRM validation (Widevine, FairPlay, PlayReady)**, **OTT/TV streaming, and secure content delivery** with **14+ years** of enterprise QA experience. Increased **DRM-protected playback success by 30%**, reduced production defects by **60%+**, and accelerated regression cycles by **73%+** across large-scale streaming platforms. Expert in **multi-platform streaming QA** (Web, Mobile iOS/Android, Smart TV), REST/GraphQL API testing, CI/CD pipeline integration, and end-to-end license acquisition and entitlement validation. Proven track record delivering zero critical defect releases in complex, high-concurrency streaming and billing environments. Open to remote work and relocation.

95%

Regression Coverage

73%

Faster Regression

80%

Pre-Integration Defect Block

## CORE COMPETENCIES

- DRM Testing (Widevine, FairPlay, PlayReady)
- OTT / TV Streaming Platform QA
- Playback & Content Delivery Validation
- License Acquisition & Token Expiry Testing
- Entitlement & Subscription Flow Testing
- Multi-Platform QA (Web, iOS, Android, TV)
- REST & GraphQL API Testing
- CDN & Geo-restriction Validation
- CI/CD Integration (Jenkins, Git, Github, GitLab)
- Node.js Automation Frameworks
- Playwright (Trained)
- Agile / Scrum QA Delivery
- Risk-Based & Shift-Left Testing
- Defect Management (Jira) & RCA

## DRM & STREAMING QA EXPERTISE

- DRM Validation (Widevine / FairPlay / PlayReady):** Deep expertise validating DRM license acquisition flows, token expiry handling, key rotation, offline playback entitlement, and cross-platform DRM compatibility — directly improving DRM-protected playback success rate by **30%**.
- Entitlement & Subscription Testing:** End-to-end validation of subscription tiers, concurrent stream limits, geo-blocking, regional content access rules, and paywall enforcement across Web, iOS, Android, and Smart TV.
- Playback & Content Delivery:** Validated adaptive bitrate (ABR) streaming, HLS/DASH manifest integrity, CDN failover, buffering under degraded network conditions, and codec-level playback validation.
- Edge-Case & Resilience Testing:** Simulated real-world edge cases including concurrent stream conflicts, network interruptions, expired licenses, and geo-spoofed access — strengthening platform reliability under live traffic conditions.
- Multi-Platform Coverage:** Maintained consistent DRM and playback QA across Web (Chrome, Firefox, Safari), iOS (AVFoundation/FairPlay), Android (ExoPlayer/Widevine), and Smart TV (Tizen, webOS) environments.
- API-First Security Testing:** Validated DRM licence server endpoints, and secure token exchange flows via REST API testing.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Quality Engineering Lead — OTT / DRM / Streaming  
Kaltura — Noida, India

April 2024 – Present

- Increased **DRM-protected playback success rate by 30%** by identifying and resolving critical failures in **license acquisition, token expiry, and entitlement validation** flows across Widevine and FairPlay.
- Reduced **critical production incidents by 40%** in 6 months through risk-based QA focused on high-impact streaming, subscription, and content-access journeys.

- Built a **Node.js automation framework** achieving **95% regression coverage**, cutting execution time by **73%** and enabling daily confident release validation.
- Shifted defect detection left, catching **80% of issues pre-integration** via CI/CD pipelines (Jenkins, GitLab), significantly reducing release rollbacks.
- Prevented high-severity content access failures by simulating **geo-blocking, concurrent stream limits, and DRM edge cases**, improving platform reliability under real-world conditions.
- Improved **defect resolution turnaround by 50%** through structured triage, precise defect reporting, and tight cross-functional engineering collaboration.
- Championed **ATDD-driven validation** in Agile sprints, reducing rework cycles by **35%** and improving acceptance-criteria accuracy.

**Consultant – Senior QA Engineer** — Automation & Streaming  
GlobalLogic — Noida, India

January 2018 – April 2024

- Reduced **production defect leakage by 60%** by redesigning QA strategy around high-risk OTT workflows, playback services, and user-critical content-access scenarios.
- Accelerated **regression cycles by 80%** through scalable **Node.js automation frameworks** for API and integration-layer testing.
- Increased **early-stage defect detection by 50%+** by validating backend systems (content delivery, subscriptions, playback services) prior to release.
- Eliminated **75% of redundant test cases**, improving CI/CD signal quality and enabling faster, data-driven release decisions.
- Enabled leadership visibility through **QA dashboards and defect analytics**, improving release predictability across multiple concurrent product lines.
- Improved **acceptance criteria quality** through cross-functional collaboration, reducing requirement gaps and rework by **30%**.

**Senior QA Engineer** — Automation & Integration Testing  
Zenith System Solutions — Mumbai, India

June 2017 – December 2017

- Reduced **end-to-end test cycle time by 83%** by implementing automation-first testing with reusable, maintainable components.
- Prevented critical production failures by strengthening **integration coverage** across distributed system boundaries.
- Improved team productivity by mentoring engineers on structured test design and reporting practices.

**Solution Integrator (QA)** — System & Integration Testing  
Ericsson — Gurgaon, India

November 2013 – June 2017

- Achieved **98% system test coverage** across complex, high-volume telecom platforms handling mission-critical transactions.
- Reduced **manual regression effort by 60%** through automation of critical billing and workflow validation.
- Prevented **revenue-impacting defects** through rigorous end-to-end billing and transaction system validation.
- Improved **defect turnaround time by 55%** via structured triage and cross-functional defect lifecycle management.

**QA Subject Matter Expert** — Billing & CRM Platforms  
Amdocs — Pune, India

July 2011 – November 2013

- Delivered **zero critical production defects** across multiple large-scale enterprise CRM and charging system releases.
- Standardised **QA reporting and defect tracking**, increasing fix rates and release transparency across distributed teams.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

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|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>DRM &amp; Security</b>     | Widevine, FairPlay, PlayReady, license acquisition, CDM validation, PSSH, token/key testing                                                                             |
| <b>Streaming QA Platforms</b> | HLS, DASH, ABR, playback validation, CDN failover, buffering, codec testing, manifest integrity<br>Web (Chrome, Safari, Firefox), iOS, Android, Smart TV (Tizen, webOS) |
| <b>API Testing</b>            | REST, GraphQL, Postman, entitlement API testing                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Automation</b>             | Node.js, Playwright (Trained)                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>CI/CD</b>                  | Jenkins, GitLab, GitHub, pipeline-embedded quality validation                                                                                                           |
| <b>Defect Mgmt</b>            | Jira, structured triage, RCA, defect lifecycle management, QA dashboards                                                                                                |
| <b>Methodologies</b>          | Agile/Scrum, Risk-Based Testing, Shift-Left Testing, ATDD, BDD                                                                                                          |

## EDUCATION

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| <b>Master of Computer Applications (MCA)</b><br><i>Pune University, India</i>     | <i>2008 – 2011</i> |
| <b>Bachelor of Computer Applications (BCA)</b><br><i>Panjab University, India</i> | <i>2005 – 2008</i> |

## CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

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- **ISTQB Foundation Level** – International Software Testing Qualifications Board
  - **CAST** – Certified Associate in Software Testing (QAI)
  - **ITIL V3 Certified** – IT Infrastructure Library (Service Management)
  - **CCNA** – Cisco Certified Network Associate
  - **Playwright Automation** – Trained (modern browser automation & API testing)

## AWARDS & RECOGNITION

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- **Star Performer** — Kaltura: Recognised for 30% DRM playback improvement and zero-rollback release delivery.
  - **League of Extraordinaire** — GlobalLogic: Recognised for scaling OTT QA practices across distributed teams with 60% defect reduction.
  - **Fast & Flawless** — Ericsson: Recognised for 98% system coverage and billing system defect prevention.
  - **Star Award** — Amdocs: Recognised for delivering critical releases ahead of schedule while maintaining zero production defects.